FLEXIPLE PRODUCT INTERN ASSIGNMENT · PRE-ALPHA PROTOTYPE

# GCC Atlas — India’s GCC ecosystem, made searchable.

Provenance-first city, policy and company comparison for India capability-centre decisions: every number carries its source, its date, and its counting denominator.

**WORKING TITLE — name collision flagged (S38)**

**COMPOSITES FROM EVIDENCE — NO INTERVIEWS CONDUCTED**

| GCCS (PARENT-LEVEL) | GCC UNITS | OF 2025 OFFICE ABSORPTION | GCC REVENUE FY26 |
|---|---|---|---|
| 2,117 | 3,728 | 39% | $98.4B |
| FY2026 · S01/S02 | FY2026 · S01 | CBRE · S20 | Nasscom–Zinnov · S02 |

Prototype runs from the repo: `npm run setup && npm run seed && npm run dev:api` + `npm run dev:web` (full walkthrough: deployment/demo-walkthrough.md)

PROBLEM

# The problem: fragmented intelligence, costly decisions

India’s GCC ecosystem is large, fast and definitionally messy — the decision layer above company directories is nowhere assembled.

GCCS PARENT-LEVEL FY2026

**2,117**

Nasscom–Zinnov · S01/S02

FY2026 REVENUE

**$98.4B**

same series · S02; 3 adds independent confirm

OF 2025 OFFICE-ABSORPTION IS GCCS

**39%**

CBRE leasing records · S20/S22

- **8+ state policies in 8+ formats.** Karnataka, TN, UP, Gujarat, Kerala… each publish subsidy tables in different shapes (payroll %, land subsidy, stamp duty, OPEX caps) — normalizing them is manual analyst work (S05–S19).
- **Counting regimes conflict.** 2,117 GCCs / $98.4B (Nasscom–Zinnov, S02) vs "$164B / 4.2M jobs" (Wizmatic via Statesman, S04 — low-confidence definitional outlier, registered as a conflict, never averaged).
- **The comparison is done by consultants on 3–6-week cycles.**A build-vs-lease decision uses brokerage PDFs + press releases + Excel (S01, S24); a defensible shortlist with citations can take weeks to assemble.
- **Source quality varies wildly.** DIY city directories contain row-level coding mistakes (GCC Village: ~473 Hyderabad vs ~100 Bengaluru rows, S35) that can misinform a location case.

Everything above is cited; no market-size figure on this slide is our own estimate.

STAKEHOLDERS (composite personas, evidence-based)

# Who feels the information asymmetry

PRIMARY — designed for

## Priya Raman

Location-strategy lead, MNC expansion desk

- Translates headcount mandate → city criteria
- Needs ranked prospects w/ talent + cost + subsidy facts
- Must defend the shortlist to CFO + consultants
- Fears "why is this number different?" in review

Basis: 64% of GCC space take-up by her class of buyer (S20,S21); UK/US firms drive 37–45% of India office absorption (S24). Composites; no interviews.

secondary — served

## Rakesh

State investment-promotion (IPA) officer

- Competes vs peer states with numbers, not slogans
- Wants a shareable neutral page for prospects
- Fears third-party tables painting the state unfairly

Basis: 8+ states run GCC-acquisition playbooks with published targets (S05,S10,S13,S16). Secondary persona — distribution catalyst in v1.

secondary — served

## Maya

Provider / enabler BD lead (RE, legal, staffing)

- Wants ready-to-engage demand signals
- Currently pays $3.5K–$10K for lead surfaces (S30)
- v1 gives her nothing to pay for — trust cultivated first

Basis: GCC Explorer monetizes exactly this class (S30); AIM watchlists purchased by this class (S32).

Anti-personas by design: job-seekers (no JTBD) and competitor scrapers. Everything persona-labelled as [inference] through Phase-3 validation gates.

COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE (verified, S30–S38)

# Current workarounds and where they stop

## GCC Explorer (AIM Research)

1,680+ GCC directory, daily analyst updates, contacts, watchlists. $3,500–$10,000 per seat cycle; free tier = 15 companies (S30/S31/S32).

**Their gap:** Not a city-DECISION tool: no policy-incentive normalization, no side-by-side compare with counting denominators (S30 pages reviewed).

## Consultancies (CBRE/JLL/Zinnov)

Authoritative bespoke decks; mandates; human nuance (S01, S20–S24).

**Their gap:** Time + fees; 3–6 week cycles; not self-serve at session speed.

## State portals + PIB PDFs

Primary-source truth; free (S05–S19).

**Their gap:** 8+ formats; conflicting denominators; normalization is analyst hours.

## DIY directories (GCC Village et al.)

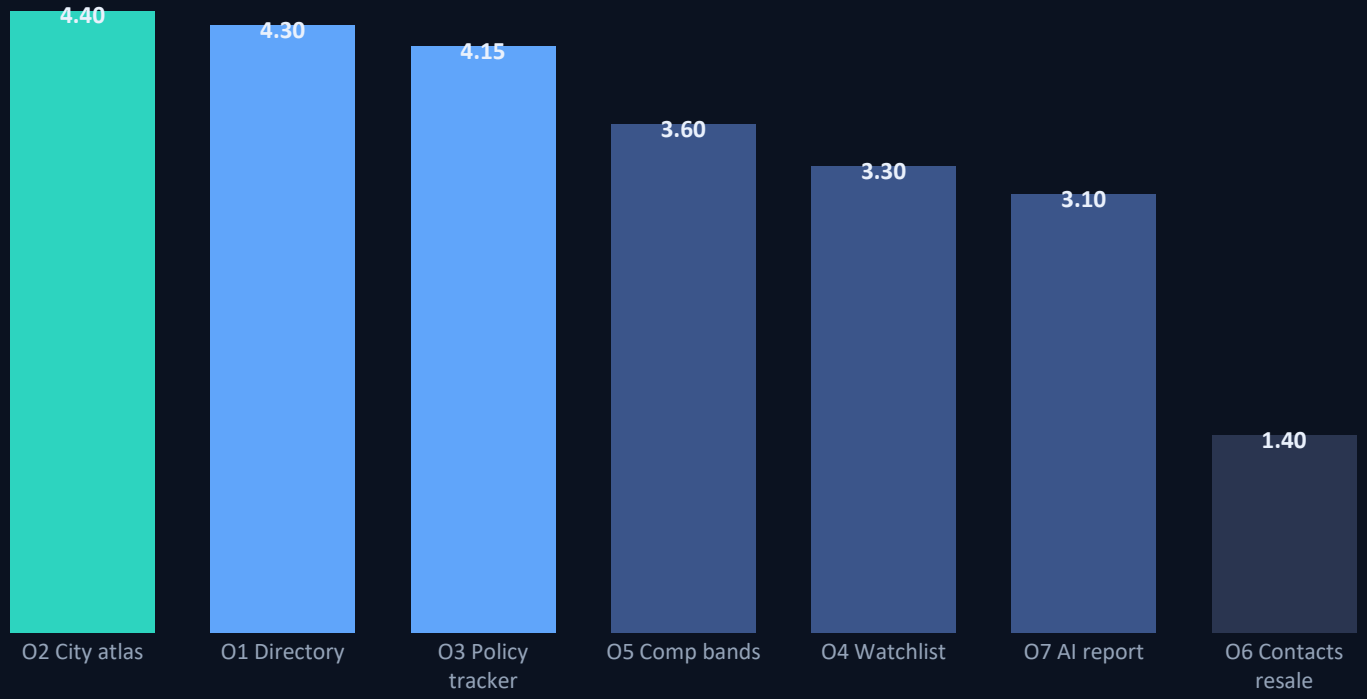
Free coverage slices (S35–S37).

**Their gap:** Row-level coding inconsistencies (S35); unverified; no provenance.

**White space we occupy:** a free, provenance-linked city-vs-city comparison layer with explicit counting denominators — no verified analog exists across the scanned landscape.

SCORING (research/opportunity-prioritization.md)

# Opportunity map and prioritization




Scores = weighted TAM / underservedness / public-data feasibility / prototype fit / risk (weights 20/30/25/15/10). Method + rubric documented in research/opportunity-prioritization.md.

## WINNER: O2 — the decision layer

- **City atlas + location-comparison** is the most underserved, most buildable surface (O2 score 4.40).
- **O1 directory and O3 policy tracker ship as** supporting modules inside it.
- **Deliberately excluded:** contact-data resale (O6: name/legal risk, S38), watchlists/O4 (needs live ingestion infrastructure), comp-band library (O5: licensing cost, Phase-3 candidate).
- **Falsification path:** if a real expansion desk says a one-week spreadsheet solves it, we pivot to O4 (documented in research §6).

PRIMARY SEGMENT

# Initial target customer and the job to be done

## Job statement (from primary persona)

> "Compare candidate cities for a new GCC — talent, policies, real-estate cost and sector peers — for a specific function, with every number carrying its counting denominator and its source."

- **JTBD 1 — Frame:** mandate → city criteria (function, tier, cost ceiling).
- **JTBD 2 — Shortlist:** ranked candidates with facts (talent, rent, subsidy).
- **JTBD 3 — Defend:** comparison survives CFO + consultant scrutiny, cited.
- **JTBD 4 — Act:** know exactly which IPA contact / subsidy applies (TN 30/20/10% payroll bands S06; UP ₹20,000/fresher S10).

## Why this segment first

- **Documented demand density:** US/global firms drove 37–45% of recent office absorption; this class pays for location intelligence (CBRE/JLL advisory hours, S20–S24; GCC Explorer $3.5K–$10K, S30).
- **Worst information-workflow fit:** 8+ policy formats + conflicting market counts = exactly the asymmetry documented in market-research §2–3.
- **Reachable for validation** via IPA relationships + expansion-team desks (both self-identify publicly) [inference].
- **Acceptance is measurable:** M1 time-to-answer metric is instrumentable end-to-end.

**[inference] items bound for Phase-3 interviews**

WHAT IS BUILT (running prototype)

# The product and its differentiated value proposition

**One line:** evidence-first India GCC location intelligence — the decision layer above directories, below bespoke consulting ("free to look, defensible to reuse").

### City Intelligence

12 tracked cities × 6+ metrics; side-by-side compare of 2–4 cities w/ metric definitions, units and EST flags.

dataset: tracked records only (scope-labelled)

### Policy matrix

State incentives normalized vs source G.O.s; draft/final states distinct; "not yet tracked" ≠ 0 (Kerala dual targets co-labelled, S16 vs S18).

### Provenance everywhere

46 GCC records, 36 sources; every figure → source chip → publisher, URL, pub date, verification date, confidence.

seed linter fails a build on sourceless values

### Cited AI assistant

Retrieval-pack answers; only retrieved evidence may be cited; hallucinated ids stripped (tested); recommendations separated, basis-labelled; declines when evidence is thin.

demo mode composes deterministically without a key

### Saved research + share

Session-scoped server-side persistence (cross-session isolation tested); share links; CSV export.

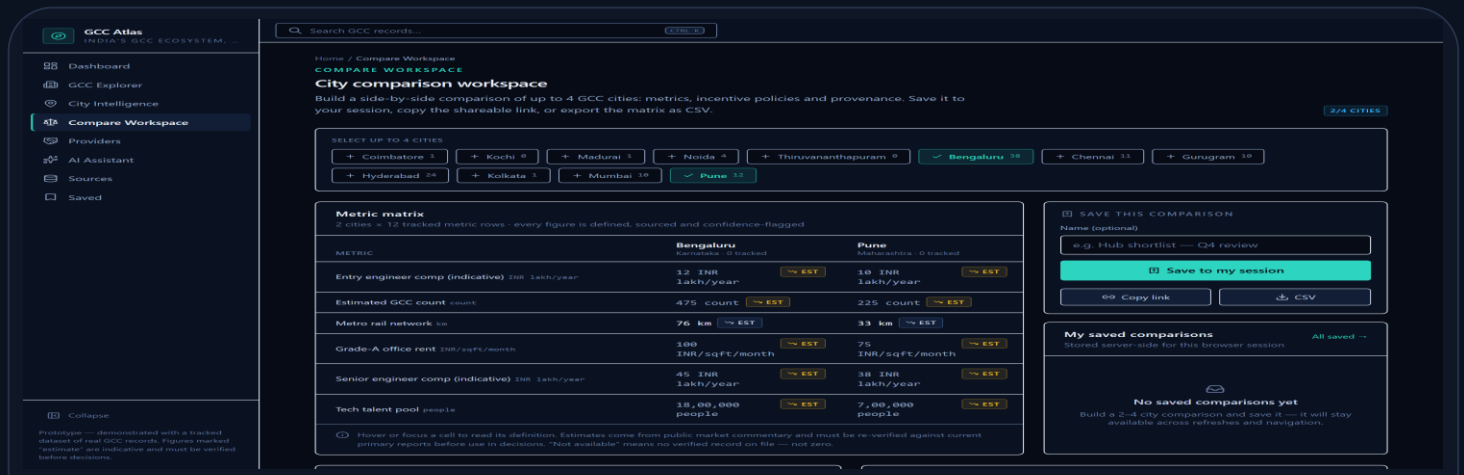
### Event instrumentation

PRD §3.5 catalog (search, detail_view, compare_create, source_click, export, saved_create…) — hashed session keys; aggregate admin.

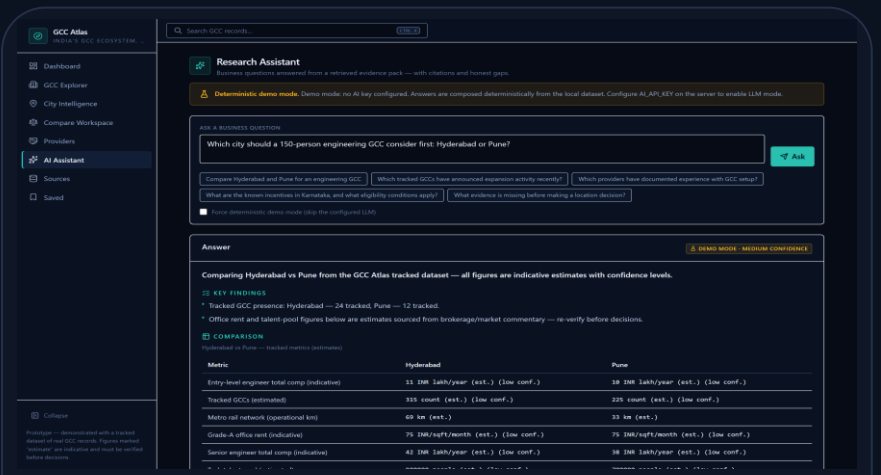
All coverage claims are dataset-scope-labelled; the app never claims the 2,117 national count as its own data.

SCREENSHOTS (headless-browser captures of the running build)

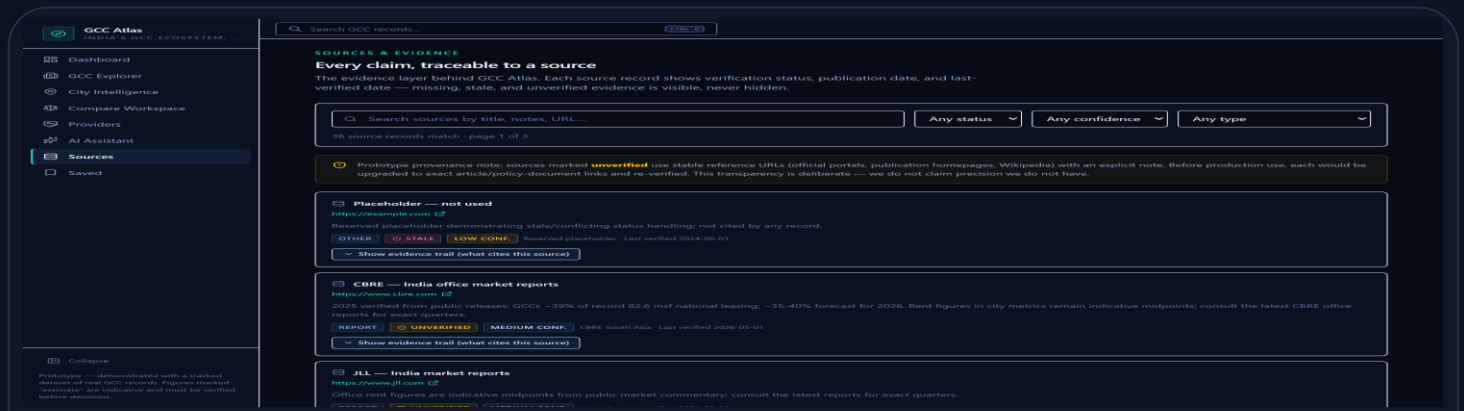
# Product walkthrough — genuine prototype captures




Compare Workspace: Bengaluru vs Pune — EST flags, metric definitions, provenance chips, save/copy-link.




Assistant: structured, cited answer (demo mode).




Sources: publisher, confidence, verification date + reverse "where used" per source.




Dashboard: dataset-scope counters + verification ledger.

GO-TO-MARKET SEQUENCING [most steps are hypotheses]

# Positioning and stakeholder adoption strategy

**Category we aim to create:** "evidence-first India GCC location intelligence" — decision layer above directories, below bespoke consulting. We never out-claim Nasscom–Zinnov/CBRE; their data is our source of record (competitive-landscape §4).

### 1. IPAs share

Free, cited compare links let state IPAs position themselves fairly vs peer states — they become our distribution catalysts (no engine gas needed, S05–S19; S12 shows IPAs actively pitch at NASSCOM events).

### 2. Providers inspect

Provider/BD leads verify claims pre-meeting (this class already pays $3.5K–$10K for similar surfaces, S30 — awareness follows the free tier).

### 3. Expansion desks adopt

Priya-style desks self-serve pre-work, arrive at consultant conversations evidence-armed; conversion to paid only AFTER free-tier trust (M1/M3 instrumented).

**What we deliberately DON'T do:** no paid ranking anywhere facts are shown (trust contract), no bulk contact-data resale (O6, name/legal risk S38), no interviews implied in any deck claim (Phase-3 validates all [inference] tags).

ALL PRICING = [proposal], UNVALIDATED

# Business-model hypotheses and go-to-market

**H1 · Free core (now)**

City compare + policy matrix + source register stay free. Reputation density is the wedge; paying for data pre-trust kills it (business-model §1).

**H2 · Pro seats [proposal]**

$99–$199/yr individual; $500–$2,000/yr teams of 3–5 — anchored at 3–6% of the market compar's $3.5K–$10K cycles (S30). Gate: free-tier traction first.

**H4 · Reports [proposal]**

Free quarterly standard; $299–$499 thematic deep-dives once publishing muscle exists (market precedent: free quarterly exists S31; historic $9,999 static lists S33).

**H5 · Provider verified [proposal]**

$199–$499/yr verified-profile attributes only — zero influence on rankings/answers; banned-paid-ranking is a standing product rule (business-model §4).

**GTM hypotheses [proposal, no spend]:** content-catalyst loop (share links) + expansion-desk outreach + token funnel metrics (M3 search→detail ≥40%; M1 median <10 min — BOTH are unvalidated targets until Phase 3 instrumentation reports).

GUARDRAILS THE BUILD ACTUALLY ENFORCES

# Data trust, AI reliability, risks and success metrics

## Trust contract (enforced in code, not just values)

- **Every figure sourced:** seed linter FAILS the build on a sourceless value (F6); provenance chips on all numeric surfaces.
- **Denominators labelled:** "GCCs, parent vs units" named at every count (S01/S02-style conflict rendered, never averaged).
- **Conflicts co-shown:** $98.4B (S02) vs $164B (S04) both visible, flagged as contested.
- **Missing ≠ zero:** "not yet tracked", draft policies flagged; placeholder sources labelled "stale".
- **AI cites or declines:** only retrieved evidence citable; unknown citation ids stripped in tests; insufficiency is an honest low-confidence path; recommendations never blended into facts.

## Risks + metrics (targets are [proposals])

- **Coverage honesty:** 46-company tracked subset; never billed as "all 2,117 GCCs" (S02/S30 context).
- **Name collision:** gcc-atlas.com exists (S38) — working-title label everywhere; trademark check is a Phase-3 gate.
- **Data freshness:** verify-by dates shown; manual re-verification pass scheduled at submission.

| | |
|---|---|
| **M1** | Time-to-answer < 10 min [proposal] |
| **M2** | 100% of displayed figures carry sources (hard invariant); assistant ≥95% answered w/ ≥1 citation [proposal] |
| **M3** | Search→detail ≥40% [proposal] |
| **M4-M6** | compare/assistant/provider engagement + no-paid-ranking guardrail countermetrics |

PHASE GATES (product/roadmap.md)

# Roadmap, prototype and next steps

### Phase 2 — DONE: working prototype

- Research → strategy → full build (Phases 1–8)
- Retrieval→citation pipeline + demo fallback
- Rate limits, events, session ACL, QA report (94+14 tests green)
- Deployment guide + render.yaml + this deck

### Phase 3 — validation loop

- 0→1 interviews to replace [inference] tags (5+ expansion desks, 2+ IPAs)
- Re-calibrate M1/M3 targets from real funnel data
- Trademark check (S38) → rename-or-keep decision

### Phase 4 — paid options (gated)

- H2 seats only after free-traction gate; H3 workspaces; H5 provider profiles under neutrality rules
- Monitoring layer F17 if O2 survives falsification tests

**The bet, honestly framed:** the market is undeniably real and growing; the intelligence layer above it is fragmented and expensive; a discipline-first free comparator is buildable and differentiated. What we have NOT proven: demand (no interviews), willingness-to-pay (proposals only), and defensibility against a fast follower. Every one of those is instrumented to be falsifiable in Phase 3 — which is the point.

Prototype + demo script: deployment/demo-walkthrough.md · QA evidence: qa/quality-report.md · Full evidence register: research/source-register.csv · Deck sources: product/deck-evidence-sources.md